

“A SINGLE SILVER BULLET CANNOT MEET ALL THE CHALLENGES IN THE IoT SPACE”

The Internet of Things (IoT) has become the next big thing in the technology world. But there are some big challenges to be overcome. **Jagdish Harsh, founder and chief managing director of Mobiloitte**, an IT company based in New Delhi, Singapore, UK and USA focusing on bots, apps, digital and IoT, discusses these challenges with **Jagmeet Singh of OSFY** and highlights the potential of the growing IoT space for Indian developers. Edited excerpts...



Q How has IoT evolved in India?

IoT has evolved significantly across the globe. You can find some great examples of this evolution in Singapore, Denmark and Spain. And this same pace of growth is catching on in India with the government's clear focus on digitisation and the huge budget allocation around connected healthcare. A few focused companies are taking the initiative in this space, on their own.

There is a large pool of well-trained medical professionals available in India, which has helped to enhance the potential of IoT developments in the healthcare sector. Also, the government has provided policy support to IoT enablers by reducing excise and custom duties, and offering exemptions in service tax.

Having said that, manufacturers, entrepreneurs, software/hardware specialists and domain experts from all sectors need to collaborate and work hand-in-hand to set the right expectations. Apart from harnessing technology around IoT, empowering people in rural areas by making the solution platform affordable is likely to be the key to drive the growth of connected devices.

The medical tourism market in India is reported to have had a turnover of around US\$ 3.9 billion in 2016 and is predicted to hit US\$ 8 billion by 2020. This is a major reason for manufacturers to develop new healthcare-focused IoT devices. Some new drug testing laboratories are also being established to advance medical services and help the government develop the country as a global healthcare hub in the near future.

The turnover of the global IoT market is expected to cross US\$ 220 billion by 2020.